

Saturday, 1 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 26° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 14°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 20° 12°	GLASGOW Light rain 17° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A disgraced funeral director who failed to bury bodies and gave bereaved families the ashes of strangers has been jailed for 20 years.

Robert Bush caused 'pain on a scale beyond comprehension,' lying about cremations and failing to provide proper services. His actions have deeply impacted numerous families across the UK.

CRIME · UK
- 2

England and Wales are on track for their driest July on record, with Met Office figures indicating the lowest rainfall in 190 years.

This prolonged dry spell is raising concerns about water resources and potential impacts on agriculture. Satellite images already show significant 'vegetation stress' across many areas.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 3

The Prime Minister has announced that regional mayors will receive a share of income tax, a move aimed at devolving power from Westminster.

Andy Burnham says this will empower 'every postcode' across Britain, though critics are calling for more detail on how the plans will be implemented. It's part of a broader strategy to redistribute power.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

A trial for puberty blockers can now begin recruiting children after a High Court judge rejected a legal challenge from campaigners.

This decision allows the trial to proceed, despite legal action brought by groups aiming to prevent it. The trial's progress will be closely watched by all sides.

HEALTH · UK
- 5

Sainsbury's has agreed to sell Argos for £120 million, though the popular retailer will still operate within Sainsbury's stores.

Under the deal, Argos will continue to sell Habitat products and offer Nectar points to customers. It marks a significant change for both well-known British brands.

BUSINESS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Former England football star Shaun Wright-Phillips is set to join the line-up for the next series of Strictly Come Dancing.**

The sportsman, whose father is Arsenal legend Ian Wright, played for clubs including Manchester City. He'll be swapping the pitch for the dancefloor, hoping to impress the judges.

ON AIR – Can Shaun follow in his dad Ian Wright's footsteps and impress on Strictly? Who do you think would be a great celebrity dancer?

TV · AUTUMN 2026

2 **Ed Sheeran's foundation is expanding its reach to the island of Ireland, funding a project that brings young musicians together.**

The Ed Sheeran Foundation is initially supporting 'North South Sounds 2026', uniting 50 young artists from Belfast and Cork. It's a wonderful initiative to foster musical talent.

ON AIR – It's 'amazing' to see Ed Sheeran supporting young musicians. What's the best way to encourage new talent in music?

MUSIC · 2026

3 **Zendaya has spoken about working with Tom Holland on their latest Spider-Man film, saying it's 'easy' when you're best friends.**

The couple walked the white carpet at the London premiere of 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day'. Their decade-long romance has blossomed alongside their on-screen partnership.

ON AIR – Zendaya and Tom Holland say it's easy working together as best friends. Do you think it's better to work with friends or keep work and friendships separate?

FILM · NOW

4 **Glasgow is taking centre stage in the new 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' film, doubling as the iconic New York City.**

Scotland's largest city provides the backdrop for the latest instalment of the Marvel cinematic universe. It's a fantastic showcase for Glasgow on the big screen.

ON AIR – Glasgow standing in for New York in the new Spider-Man film – which other UK cities have successfully 'played' famous locations in movies?

FILM · NOW

5 **The Mahrajan Festival, celebrating Arabic culture, is making its debut in London with a line-up including Saint Levant and Dystinct.**

Organisers hope the festival will be a 'milestone' for the Arabic community in the UK. It promises to be a vibrant event showcasing diverse musical talent.

ON AIR – The Mahrajan Festival is a 'milestone' for the Arabic community. What cultural festivals are you looking forward to seeing in the UK this year?

MUSIC · SOON

On the schedule

1 **Eddie Howe has resigned as head coach of Newcastle United after nearly five years in charge of the club.**

Howe's departure comes as a surprise to many, after a successful period that saw the club return to European football. The search for his successor will now begin.

ON AIR – Eddie Howe leaving Newcastle – who do you think should be the next manager at St James' Park? What qualities do they need?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Southern Brave have secured their first win in the men's Hundred, successfully defending 128 against Birmingham Phoenix.**

They defeated the Phoenix by 12 runs at the Utilita Bowl in a thrilling encounter. It's a crucial early victory for the Brave in this year's competition.

ON AIR – Southern Brave get their first win in The Hundred. Are you following The Hundred this year, and who are you tipping for success?

CRICKET · UK

3 **World number two Jeeno Thitikul leads the first round of the AIG Women's Open after a spectacular seven-under 64.**

She holds a two-shot lead at Royal Lytham & St Anne's, with Britons Lottie Woad and Charley Hull also featuring in the best shots. It's set to be an exciting tournament.

ON AIR – Jeeno Thitikul is leading the Women's Open after a brilliant first round. Who are you hoping to see lift the trophy this weekend?

GOLF · UK

4 **Cameron Norrie's resurgent form continues as he powered past Bernard Tomic in just 50 minutes at the Los Cabos Open.**

Norrie's dominant performance sees him progress to the semi-finals in Mexico. He's looking in great shape as he builds momentum on the tour.

ON AIR – Cameron Norrie is on a great run of form. Who is your favourite British tennis player to watch right now, and why?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

5 **The Tour de France Femmes begins in Lausanne, Switzerland on Saturday, with a historic first ascent of Mont Ventoux to come.**

This year's race promises to be a thrilling spectacle, with some of the world's best female cyclists competing. The iconic Mont Ventoux climb will be a major challenge.

ON AIR – The Tour de France Femmes is underway, with a historic climb of Mont Ventoux. What's the most impressive sporting feat you've ever witnessed?

CYCLING · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 The simple pleasure of a good old-fashioned picnic is making a delightful comeback this summer.**
Families and friends are rediscovering the joy of packing a basket, a blanket, and heading outdoors for an al fresco meal, proving that sometimes the simplest ideas are the best.
- 2 A new trend sees people embracing 'book swaps' to refresh their reading piles without spending a penny.**
It's a wonderful way to discover new authors and genres, connecting communities over a shared love of stories, and giving much-loved books a new lease of life.
- 3 The satisfying ritual of sorting through old photographs is being hailed as a new mindful activity.**
Many are finding peace and nostalgia in reliving memories and organising their cherished prints, creating a lovely link to the past in our digital age.
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the gentle art of 'letterboxing' – a treasure hunt combining orienteering, art, and puzzle-solving.**
Participants follow clues to find hidden boxes, often containing a unique stamp to mark their logbook, offering a fun, active way to explore the outdoors.
- 5 The comforting sound of rain on a tin roof is being celebrated as a surprisingly popular relaxation aid.**
Many are seeking out recordings or even just pausing to listen during a shower, finding its rhythmic patter incredibly soothing for unwinding after a busy day.
- 6 More people are discovering the quiet joy of 'nature journaling' – sketching and writing observations from the garden or a local park.**
It's a lovely way to slow down, notice the small wonders of the natural world, and engage creativity without needing to be a professional artist.
- 7 The classic game of 'hide and seek' is experiencing a resurgence, not just with children but among adults too, as a fun, active way to destress.**
Organised groups are even forming for playful games in parks and open spaces, proving that some childhood joys never truly fade.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to decide what to cook for dinner?

ANSWER: ...OPENING THE FRIDGE DOOR MULTIPLE TIMES, HOPING FOR A NEW IDEA TO MAGICALLY APPEAR!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot bath. What is it?

ANSWER: ...TESTING THE WATER WITH THEIR ELBOW AT LEAST THREE TIMES, EVEN AFTER THE TAP IS OFF!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little everyday moments' that just make you feel instantly content, don't we?**
What's that one small, simple thing that never fails to bring a smile to your face – perhaps the first sip of tea, or a perfectly buttered piece of toast? Give us a call and share your happy little moments!

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' instantly takes you back to a specific memory or a moment in time?**
Is there a scent – perhaps baking bread, old books, or freshly cut grass – that just instantly transports you somewhere special? We'd love to hear your 'smell memory' stories!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know, the 'Northern Lights' or Aurora Borealis can sometimes be heard? Under very specific circumstances, witnesses have reported a crackling, rustling, or swishing sound accompanying the light display.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of flamingos is a 'flamboyance'. However, if they are all standing on one leg, they are known as a 'balance'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.9 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.9 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest chameleon, *Brookesia nana*, is so tiny it can sit comfortably on the tip of your finger.
- Bumblebees have 'fur' on their eyes, which helps them collect pollen more efficiently.
- The 'smell of rain' actually has a name: petrichor, and it's caused by a combination of plant oils and a bacteria called actinomyces.
- A group of ferrets is called a 'business'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The oldest piece of chewing gum ever found is over 9,000 years old and was discovered in Finland.
- Flamingos are not born pink; their vibrant colour comes from beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae.
- The distinctive stripes of a zebra are as unique as a human fingerprint, with no two zebras having the exact same pattern.

On this day

Day 213 of the year, 152 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Lebanon); Armed Forces Day (China) or Anniversary of the Founding of the People's Liberation Army (People's Republic of China); Azerbaijani Language and Alphabet Day (Azerbaijan); Emancipation Day is commemorated in many parts of the former British Empire, which marks the day the Slavery Abolition Act 1833 came into effect which abolished chattel slavery in the British Empire: Emancipation Day is a public holiday in Barbados, Bermuda, Guyana, Jamaica, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Trinidad and Tobago. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Taylor Negron, American actor and screenwriter (died 2015)
- 1978 — Chris Iwelumo, Scottish footballer
- 1989 — Tiffany Young, Korean American singer, songwriter, and actress
- 1933 — Dom DeLuise, American actor, singer, director, and producer (died 2009)
- 1993 — Leon Thomas III, American actor and singer
- 1936 — Laurie Taylor, English sociologist, radio host, and academic
- 1953 — Robert Cray, American blues singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1968 — Dan Donegan, American heavy metal guitarist and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1993 — The Great Mississippi and Missouri Rivers Flood of 1993 comes to a peak.
- 2004 — A supermarket fire kills 424 people and injures 360 others in Asunción, Paraguay.
- 1976 — Niki Lauda has a severe accident that almost claims his life at the German Grand Prix at Nürburgring.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1974 — Cyprus dispute: The United Nations Security Council authorizes the UNFICYP to create the "Green Line", dividing Cyprus into two zones.
- 1981 — MTV begins broadcasting in the United States and airs its first video, "Video Killed the Radio Star" by The Buggles.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1960 — Dahomey (later renamed Benin) declares independence from France.

- 1960 — Islamabad is declared the federal capital of the Government of Pakistan.

- 1993 — The Great Mississippi and Missouri Rivers Flood of 1993 comes to a peak.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 214 of the year, 151 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ahudemme (Syriac Orthodox Church).; Christian feast day: Basil Fool for Christ (Russian Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Ceferino Giménez Malla; Christian feast day: Centola and Helen. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Wes Craven, American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2015)
- 1962 — Lee Mavers, English singer, songwriter and guitarist
- 1932 — Peter O'Toole, British-Irish actor and producer (died 2013)
- 1962 — Cynthia Stevenson, American actress
- 1960 — David Yow, American singer-songwriter
- 1961 — Pete de Freitas, Trinidadian-British drummer and producer (died 1989)
- 1982 — Kerry Rhodes, American football player
- 1955 — Butch Vig, American drummer, songwriter, and record producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1943 — The Holocaust: Jewish prisoners stage a revolt at Treblinka, one of the deadliest of Nazi death camps where approximately 900,000 persons were murdered in less than 18 months.
- 1989 — Pakistan is re-admitted to the Commonwealth of Nations after having restored democracy for the first time since 1972.
- 1937 — The Marihuana Tax Act of 1937 is passed in America, the effect of which is to render marijuana and all its by-products illegal.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1947 — A British South American Airways Avro Lancastrian airliner crashes into a mountain during a flight from Buenos Aires, Argentina to Santiago, Chile. The wreckage would not be found until 1998.
- 1968 — An earthquake hits Casiguran, Aurora, Philippines killing more than 270 people and wounding 261.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)